Rakesh Pullabhatla CPA, CFA, MBA

AI ~ FINTECH ~ DEFENSETECH ~ BLOCKCHAIN

http://www.rakeshpullabhatla.com/ http://www.linkedin.com/in/rakeshpullabhatla 650.542.6210 iamrakeshp@gmail.com

SUMMARY

Visionary finance and operations leader with 20+ years of global experience scaling startups and public companies across AI, fintech, SaaS and deeptech. Worked with multiple unicorns and helped take companies public. Proven track record of scaling businesses, securing capital, optimizing cash flow, and implementing rigorous financial controls. Adept at building financial infrastructure from the ground up, leading audits, and preparing companies for exits, M&A, or IPOs.

EXPERIENCE

Consulting CFO — Advising Seed-stage to unicorn companies ($0–$40M ARR) across AI, fintech, and blockchain

Unstructured.io (AI), Cogito AI, Helios AI, Whiterabbit.ai, Nodle and others **Apr'23 – Present, San Francisco, CA**

- Capital Strategy: Raised $200M+ in equity and debt across Seed, Series A–C (SAFE, convertible notes, priced rounds); built investor-ready financial models and pitch materials.
- Go-to-Market (GTM) Strategy: Designed and executed GTM playbooks (pricing, partnerships, channel strategy, customer segmentation) driving ARR growth and market adoption for a $500M AI client.
- M&A Preparation: Directed due diligence and financial readiness for exits and acquisitions, including a $100M acquisition and $50M strategic merger. Managed a $150M tender offer.
- Operational Efficiency: Reduced clients burn rates by 30%+ through cost analysis and organizational restructuring. Automated financial workflows and streamlined processes to improve decision-making speed and transparency.
- Finance Infrastructure: Implemented ERP systems (NetSuite, SAP, QBO, Xero) and scaled finance operations (budgeting, controls, AR/AP, SaaS metrics including LTV/CAC, churn, Magic Number, burn multiple, runway).
- Compliance & Government Projects: Led company compliance initiatives to achieve SOC 2 Type II and FedRAMP authorization, ensuring enterprise-grade security and regulatory alignment. Designed tax strategies.
- Board & Stakeholder Communication: Produced board decks and investor updates with actionable insights.

Co-Founder, CFO and COO

Haus – A real-estate RWA tokenization company **Jul'24 – Present, San Francisco, CA**

- Capital Strategy: Raised early-stage funding and secured strategic partnerships with capital market partners and blockchain ecosystems. Developed comprehensive investor materials, cap table scenarios, and tokenomic frameworks to support equity and token sales.
- Finance Infrastructure: Built finance and compliance systems from the ground up, covering FP&A, treasury, security token accounting, and platform-level performance metrics (TVL, ARR, investor IRR, LTV/CAC).
- Go-to-Market & Scaling: Drove business development and growth strategy, expanding to a $4B pipeline and a 30K+ investor waitlist. Streamlined onboarding, diligence, and underwriting workflows with AI-driven tools.
- Tokenization & RWA Structuring: Built SEC Reg D and Reg S compliant, EU MiCA-aligned on-chain RWA structures, designed to meet U.S. and European crypto-asset and securities regulatory frameworks.
- Investor & Ecosystem Relations: Managed investor communications and monthly stakeholder updates. Built strategic ties with blockchain foundations and DeFi protocols. Represented Haus at XSpaces and industry events.

CFO – CFO Advisory and IPO Readiness Services for Fintech, Proptech, SaaS and blockchain companies

Kranz Consulting (An Addison Group company) **May'18 – Apr'23, San Francisco, CA**

- Representative Clients: Brightside, Coil, Nelo, Metallicus, BalanceHomes, Loftium, Boosted, Unagi, Orro, Yotascale, Trustlayer, VHT, AltaVR, Caba, and Okera.
- Strategic Planning & FP&A: Built long-range operating models, detailed budgets, and KPI dashboards to support executive decision-making and board-level visibility across high-growth startups.
- Finance Leadership: Oversaw month-end close, GAAP financial reporting, and internal controls. Scaled accounting teams and implemented SOX-lite frameworks to support audit readiness and investor transparency.
- Fundraising & Capital Structuring: Advised founders on fundraising strategies, investor materials, SAFE vs. priced round tradeoffs, and token sale structuring. Supported companies from Seed through Series C.
- Audit & Compliance: Managed Big 4 and Big 10 audit engagements, IRS reviews, and international tax structuring. Delivered clean audit opinions for clients preparing for M&A and token launches.

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- Systems & Automation: Led deployment of NetSuite, Adaptive Insights, and finance tech stacks (including token accounting tools), automating workflows and increasing reporting accuracy and speed.
- Board & Valuation: Created board decks; led financial presentations and conducted 409(a) valuations.
- Vendor & Risk Management: Negotiated vendor contracts, implemented cost control measures, and ensured financial operations aligned with strategic growth, investor expectations, and market conditions.

Head of Finance (VP)

Swift Navigation Inc. — High-precision GNSS positioning technology **Aug'17 – May'18, San Francisco, CA**

- Strategic Planning & FP&A: Partnered with CEO and executive team to build the company's operating plan, including financial projections, KPIs, milestones, and capital requirements.
- Capital Strategy & Financial Operations: Secured over $5M in additional liquidity by negotiating debt facilities and selecting Silicon Valley Bank as primary lender.

Head of FP&A

Planet Labs PBC (NYSE: PL) — Satellite imagery and geospatial data **Jun'15 – Aug'17, San Francisco, CA**

- Strategic Planning & FP&A: Led global planning, forecasting, and analytics; built KPI dashboards and MD&A-level reports to support executive and board decision-making.
- Revenue & Deal Structuring: Analyzed pricing and margins across segments; structured enterprise and government deals generating $50M+ in recurring revenue.
- Finance Ops & Systems: Led ERP and finance tool rollouts (NetSuite, Adaptive, Salesforce); cut AWS/GCP costs 15% and in-housed manufacturing to reduce costs by 20%.
- Accounting & Capex: Managed inventory, cost accounting, and capex planning; drove spend optimizations and revaluation improvements.
- Board & Investor Relations: Built board materials and led financial presentations; supported due diligence and raised $200M+ in debt and equity.
- M&A & Corporate Dev: Led diligence and valuation for Blackbridge and Google's Terra Bella acquisitions.

Head of Finance

Gild (Acquired by Citadel LLC) — Predictive analytics for talent **Jan'13 – Jan'15, San Francisco, CA**

- Built team and managed $50M annual budget for SaaS startup offering tech recruitment ("LinkedIn for Engineers").

Director of FP&A and Controller

Boku (LON: GBX) — Mobile payments and carrier billing platform **Dec'09 – Dec'12, San Francisco, CA**

- Directed all aspects of global finance operations including FP&A and accounting for this mobile payments startup operating in 66 countries (US, LATAM, EMEA, APAC) generating $200M in revenue.

Associate at Cornerstone Research (*a litigation consulting firm***)** **Oct'08 – Nov'09, Menlo Park, CA**

Software Engineering & Product Management Roles

Apple, Textron and eCargoService **Dec'97 – Oct'08, India, San Francisco, Chicago**

EDUCATION

- MBA – Finance & Strategy, Booth School of Business, University of Chicago
- Bachelor of Engineering, National Institute of Technology, Raipur, India